101. Pradip Phanjoubam, ‘How BJP won without winning in Nagaland’, *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 53, No. 10, March 2018.
102. Ibid.
103. Ram Madhav interview with Prafulla Ketkar, Promod Kumar, ‘Need to view North East with different prism’, *Organiser*, Vol. 69, No. 38, 18 March 2018.
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105. Adam Saprisanga, ‘How Congress unraveled in Mizoram, its last bastion of power in Northeast’, 21 September 2019, https://theprint.in/politics/how-congress-unraveled-in-mizoram-its-last-bastion-of-power-in-northeast/294335/.
106. Methodology: 150+ GB of TIFF files were acquired from the NASA website, and then processed using a Python programme that Srivastava wrote. The data was mapped on to all 543 Lok Sabha constituencies by time period.
107. Utpal Prashar, ‘PM Narendra Modi urges Arunachal voters to vote for “double-engine” growth’, *Hindustan Times*, 30 March 2019, https://www.hindustantimes.com/lok-sabha-elections/lok-sabha-elections-2019-pm-narendra-modi-urges-arunachal-voters-to-vote-for-double-engine-growth/story-7KglM3GRY29YIoNV4sR04H.html.
108. Reserve Bank of India, *State Finances: A Study of Budgets of 2019–20* (Mumbai: RBI, 2019), p. 11.
109. *North Eastern Council Regional Plan (2017–18 to 2019–20)*, p. 4, http://megplanning.gov.in/circular/NEC%20Regional%20Plan%202017-18%20to%202019-20.pdf.
110. After the erstwhile Planning Commission was replaced by the NITI Aayog in January 2015, the nomenclature of ‘special category states’—which had first started in 1969 with Jammu and Kashmir, Assam and Nagaland—was no longer used. But financial benefits for such states from the Union government continued. To the original list, eight more states were added over the years (Arunachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Sikkim, Tripura and, in 2010, Uttarakhand).